

Society and Civilization

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Society is an organized group of people sharing a common culture, territory, and institutions that facilitate cooperation, such as family and government.

Civilization is an advanced, complex stage of human society characterized by urban settlements, specialized labor, social hierarchies, and technological development.

Ancient civilizations

Ancient civilizations (c. 4000 BCE – 500 CE) were the first settled, urbanized societies, primarily emerging in river valleys like Mesopotamia, Egypt, the Indus Valley, and China. These societies developed agriculture, complex social structures, writing systems, and monumental architecture. Key cradles of civilization included Mesopotamia, Egypt, Indus Valley, China, Peru, and Mexico.

Key ancient civilization

Mesopotamia(Sumer, Assyria, Babylon):Known as the oldest civilization, developing writing (cuneiform) and cities between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers.

Ancient Egypt:Famed for its complex kingdom, Nile-based agriculture, and monumental structures like pyramids.

Indus Valley Civilization:A large, highly organized urban society in modern-day Pakistan and India.

Ancient China:Emerging along the Yellow River, it was characterized by early dynasties (Xia, Shang) and agriculture.

Ancient Greece and Rome:The foundation of Western political thought, democracy, and empire, succeeding earlier Minoan and Mycenaean cultures.

Mesoamerica(Olmec, Maya, Aztec):The earliest civilizations in the Americas, noted for complex societies, astronomy, and architecture.

Key Differences Between Ancient Civilizations

Geography and Environment:

Mesopotamia: Had unstable, unpredictable flooding, leading to a more fearful, pessimistic worldview and heavily fortified city-states.

Egypt: Isolated by deserts and sustained by the predictable, gentle flooding of the Nile, fostering a more stable, confident, and centralized civilization.

Indus Valley: Focused on urban planning, featuring advanced sewage and drainage systems in cities like Mohenjo-Daro.

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Political Structure:

.Egypt/China: Centralized kingdoms where kings or emperors held absolute power (e.g., Pharaohs).

Greece/Sumer: Often operated as fragmented, independent city-states rather than a unified empire

Religion:

Mesopotamians/Mayans: Polytheistic, often requiring intense rituals to appease unpredictable gods.

Egyptians: Focused heavily on the afterlife and divine kingship.

Key stages of Evolutions

Neolithic Revolution (~10,000–4000 BCE): Warmer climates allowed for plant domestication (rice, wheat, barley) and the establishment of permanent villages.

Early City-States (~4000–3000 BCE): In Sumer (Mesopotamia), the first cities (Uruk, Ur) grew with monumental architecture, irrigation systems, and early writing (cuneiform).

Complex Kingdoms (~3000–1000 BCE): Centralized states formed, such as Ancient Egypt, which built pyramids, and the Indus Valley, which built planned cities with sanitation (Harappa, Mohenjo-daro).

Classical Age (~800 BCE–500 AD): The rise of complex empires and ideological foundations, including Greek democracy, the Hellenistic empire of Alexander the Great, and the expansion of the Roman Empire, which solidified military and civic organization in Europe.

Indus Valley

The Indus valley civilization was one of the world's first great urban civilizations. It flourished in the vast Indus river plains and adjacent regions, in what are now parts of Afghanistan, Pakistan and north-western India.





Beginning

Around five thousand years ago, an important civilization developed on the Indus River floodplain named the Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) which was a Bronze Age Civilization (3300-1300 BCE; mature period 2600-1900 BCE).

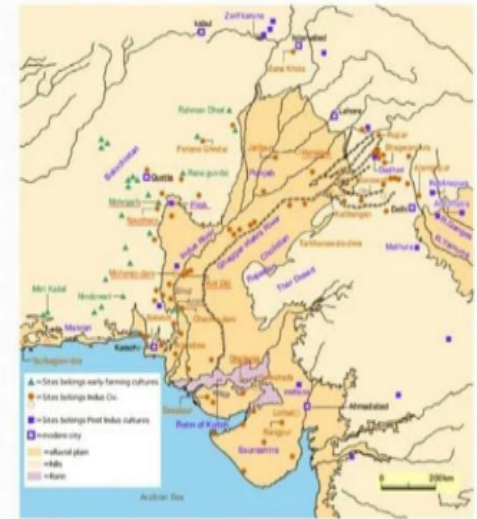
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- A collage of various prehistoric artifacts. The top row features a terracotta mask on the left, a stone tool in the center, and a red figurine on the right. The middle row shows a bone tool on the left, a collection of small bone tools in the center, and a bone structure on the right. The bottom row includes a bone necklace on the left and a bone tool on the right.

Geography of Indus Valley



- The geography of the Indus Valley put the civilizations that arose there in a highly similar situation to those in Egypt and Peru, with rich agricultural lands being surrounded by highlands, desert, and ocean.
- the civilization extended east into the Ghaggar-Hakra Rivervalley and the upper reaches Ganges-Yamuna Doab; it extended west to the Makran coast of Balochistan,
- The Indus Valley Civilization encompassed most of Pakistan, extending from Balochistan to Sindh, and extending into modern day Indian states of Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana, and Punjab, with an upward reach to Rupar on the upper Sutlej.
- Recently, Indus sites have been discovered in Pakistan's northwestern Frontier Province as well. Other IVC colonies can be found in Afghanistan while smaller isolated colonies can be found as far away as Turkmenistan and in Gujarat.

Geography of Indus Valley(cont.)



Culture of Indus Valley Civilization



Religion

- Some Indus valley seals show swastikas, which are found in other religions worldwide, especially in Indian religions such as Hinduism, Buddhism, and Jainism.
- The earliest evidence for elements of Hinduism are alleged to have been present before and during the early Harappan period.
- Shiva lingam have been found in the Harappan remains.





Between 400 and as many as 600 distinct Indus symbols have been found on seals, small tablets, ceramic pots and more than a dozen other materials, including a "signboard" that apparently once hung over the gate of the inner citadel of the Indus city of Dholavira.



Culture of Indus Valley Civilization(cont.)



Trade and transportation

- The Indus civilization's economy appears to have depended significantly on trade, which was facilitated by major advances in transport technology.
- The IVC may have been the first civilization to use wheeled transport.
- They have been used boat and sea-going craft for transportation.
- During the Early Harappan period, similarities in pottery, seals, figurines, ornaments, etc. document intensive caravan trade with Central Asia and the Iranian plateau.





Culture of Indus Valley Civilization(cont.)

Subsistence

- food production was largely indigenous to the Indus Valley.
- It is known that the people of Mehrgarh used domesticated wheats and barley, and the major cultivated cereal crop was naked six-row barley, a crop derived from two-row barley.

Cities



Mohenjo-Daro

To the north is a citadel or raised area. In Mohenjo-Daro, the citadel is built on an architectural platform about 45 feet above the plain.



Harappa

At the upper site of valley, the another city was situated named Harappa. This civilization is also called Harappa civilization.





Achievements

Carefully Planned Cities

- The cities of the Indus Valley Civilization were well-organised and solidly built out of brick and stone.
- Their drainage systems, wells and water storage systems were the most sophisticated in the ancient world.



Achievements(cont.)

Science & Technology

- The people of the Indus Civilization achieved great accuracy in measuring length, mass, and time.
- They were among the first to develop a system of uniform weights and measures.
- Harappans evolved some new techniques in metallurgy and produced copper, bronze, lead, and tin.
- The engineering skill of the Harappans was remarkable, especially in building docks.



Achievements(cont.)



Writing Skill

- The people of the Indus Valley Civilization also developed a writing system which was used for several hundred year



Government

- There was no single ruler but several: Mohenjo-daro had a separate ruler, Harappa another, and so forth.
- Harappa society had no ruler, everybody enjoyed equal status.



The Indus Valley civilization was declined at late 1900 BC. There are various theory for describe of destruction of this civilization. Some are given briefly:

- ***The Aryan Invasion Theory***

Many scholars gave a theories that an invasion of the Aryans into the subcontinent was the cause of this dispersal. But there is currently no historical or archaeological record which shows that the Aryan people ever invaded the region.





Decline of Indus Valley Civilization(cont.)

- ***The Evidence Of Natural Disaster***

The most common held theory used to explain the decline of the Harrapan culture is that climatic changes lead to a long term drought. This environmental disaster, coupled with repeated floods that devastated the arable land.

- ***The Possibility Of An Ancient Tsunami***

Some geophysicists have begun to theorize that such a disaster could have been responsible for the end of Harrapan civilization. This theory is based upon the premise that a massive wave could have reached inland, traveling up the Indus and Saraswati Rivers simultaneously.

- ***The Saraswati River Runs Dry***

The geological record does show that the Saraswati River, one of the main arteries of trade for the Harrapans, dried up completely sometime during the early 20th century B.C.E.

Effects on Human Civilization



- Actually each and every achievement make an important effects on sub-continental culture.
- The Indus Valley Civilization may have been the first civilization to use wheeled transport. These advances may have included bullock carts that are identical to those seen throughout South Asian territory today, as well as boats.
- Their well organized urbanization system make an effects on next civilization.
- Some of the crafts which were found in Harappa civilization are still practised in the subcontinent today.

Thank
you!